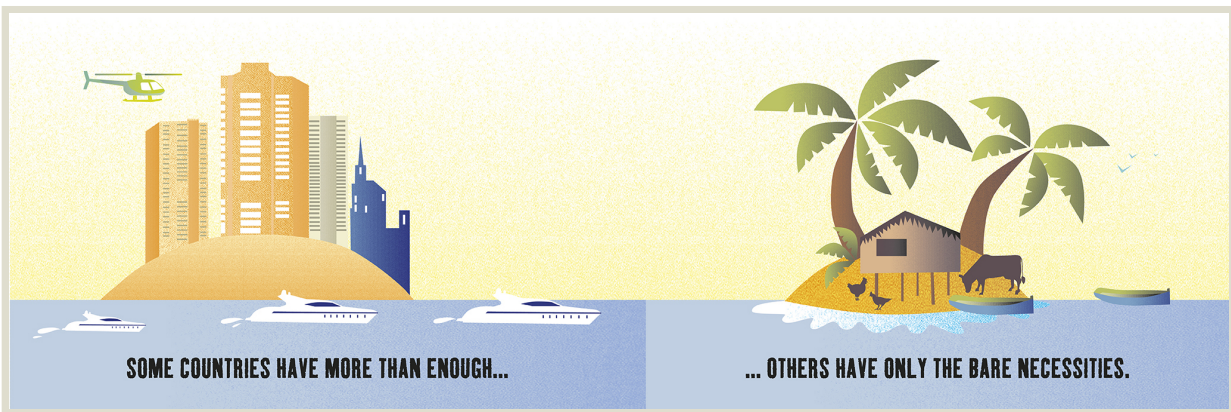


population with no industry until oil was discovered in the region. Then they suddenly became among the richest countries in the world.



Wealth and poverty

People in rich, industrialized countries can enjoy a high standard of living with all modern conveniences, but in many parts of the world it's a struggle to survive.

Held back

Many poor countries have struggled due to a lack of modern industry, leaving them unable to cash in on their resources. Many still have an agricultural economy, with small farms and fishing communities producing only enough food for local people, while larger agricultural businesses export their produce. Manufacturing industries tend to rely on cheap labor, and transporting goods is made difficult by bad roads and railroads. Some poorer countries are now being helped by investment from foreign countries and companies, and are called “developing countries.” Many governments have adopted policies to encourage modern industries, making the most of their resources and promoting trade. Money from the new industries and investment from abroad is used to improve infrastructure such as communication, roads, and power lines. Developing countries are achieving unprecedented growth, but they face continued competition from developed countries. While conditions are improving for some, much of the world’s population still lives in poverty.